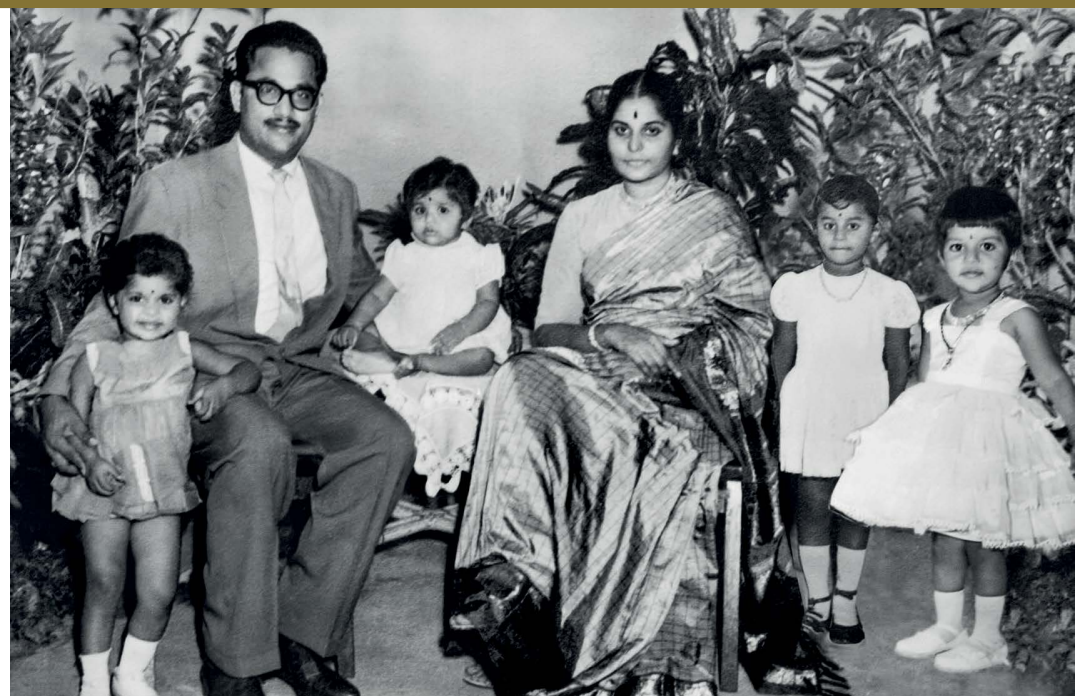


managed to meet then Prime Minister Indira Gandhi. Finally, with the government's support, he opened the first Apollo hospital in Chennai. Over the years, through strategic alliances and advocacy for systemic reforms, Apollo Hospitals has risen as a beacon of hope, offering world-class medical services for Indians. For Reddy, collaboration, compassion, and quality care are the cornerstones that have shaped Apollo. In an exclusive interaction with *Business Today*, he talks about his journey, challenges, and the way forward. Edited excerpts on the remarkable life of Dr Prathap C. Reddy, in his own words:



What was the driving force behind your decision to return to India and establish Apollo Hospitals?

During my time in the US, one of the most memorable moments was receiving a letter



FROM THE FAMILY ALBUM Dr Prathap C. Reddy and Sucharitha Reddy with their daughters (from left) Shobana, Sangita, Suneeta, and Preetha

from my father on my birthday. He expressed that whatever I was doing, it brought him and my mother joy. The essence of the letter was clear: bringing happiness to those at home through my actions. This sentiment resonated deeply with me. Although it didn't explicitly suggest returning [to India], my

wife (Sucharitha) and I decided to go back. Fortunately, with four daughters under the age of 12, there was little protest. Upon my return, I was shocked to witness the stark lack of medical infrastructure. People often resorted to seeking medical treatment abroad... That's why I used to refer my patients

to doctors overseas...

One day in 1979, I recall treating a patient [who could not afford to travel to the US]. Sadly, despite our efforts, he passed away. It was heartbreaking, considering his relatively young age of 38. Witnessing such tragedies made me question why we couldn't provide adequate cardiac care locally.

APOLLO'S STORIED JOURNEY

1983

Apollo Hospitals set up in Chennai; later, it expands to Hyderabad

1991-2000

Expands to Delhi, Madurai, and Visakhapatnam; ISO accreditation for Apollo Hospitals, Chennai

2000-2005

Apollo Hospitals, Delhi, first in India to receive JCI accreditation; expands to Bilsapur, Mysuru, Ahmedabad, and Kolkata; launches nationwide emergency number, 1066